at the behaviour of Europeans in India. The Ilbert Bill controversy taught Indians the art and science of political agitation against the negative actions of the government. These factors created the conditions for the conclusive emergence of Indian nationalism in the 19th century that powered the Indian struggle for independence.

Challenges before Nationalism

Nationalism faces a host of challenges in the contemporary period. Some of them are intra-national and many of them are extra-national in origin and theatre of operation. The paramount challenges can be listed as secessionism and globalisation.



Nationalism is the last refuge of scoundrels

- Winston Churchill

Secessionism

Today's nationalism confronts several challenges, such as separatist tendencies, such nationalism and divisive trends. The Quebec separatism in Canada, Baluchistan movement in Pakistan, Uyghur issue in China, Catalan nationalism in Spain, Scottish movement in the UK are the living examples of nationalism being questioned and endangered by intra-national forces. Religious fundamentalism, resistance to over-centralism regional in balances, loss of faith in democratic resolutions of issues are some of the major threats fostering secessionism and endangering nationalism.

Extra National Factors

Many extra-national and global factors imperil nationalism. Globalisation refers to the increasing integration of the world in terms of economy, trade, technology, culture and institutions. The contemporary world is dominated by the ascendency of globalisation process. The barriers between and among nations are being undermined by the onward march of globalisation. Economically, multi-national corporations have established their production and sale units across many countries and continents. They employ people belonging to different countries and exercise great influence in political domain also.

The establishment and functioning of World Trade Organization has hastened the process of globalisation. 'Barrier-free trade' is the fundamental slogan of the organization. It has created several agreements in the last two decades from 1995 the year of its inception and till now and has brought down the trade and tariff bottlenecks in international domain that partly contributed to the two world wars in the 20th century. Trade tariffs are closely related to nationalism and their elimination erodes the rationale of nationalism.

There is a large-scale migration of the skilled people propelled by the forces of globalisation. The highly educated and technologically qualified people migrate from Asian and African countries to the developed countries like the United States, Australia and countries of Western Europe. The educated and technologically advanced Indian and Chinese youth have migrated in large numbers to the United States in the age of globalisation.

The international regional organizations have eroded the stature of the States and their nationalism by promoting regional economic co-operation. The

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